Chokalingam said the doctors faced a lot of difficulty trying to suture the fragmented body. The skull had broken open, exposing the brain cavity, through which grey matter had been lost. The face had received too many hits, with the lips, nose and the eyes destroyed. Despite being a veteran in his field, Dr Chokalingam could not look at the mangled body of his leader for more than a minute. Earlier, he said, Dr Cecilia Cyril had found twenty-two injuries on Rajiv's body at the Madras General Hospital when asked to conduct the post mortem. She had observed that Rajiv's face was severely damaged. Deep wounds were observed on the left portion of the trunk and the face. Anirudhya hung up.

Anirudhya had been waiting outside the office of S.K. Datta for more than two hours only to find out who else had been picked to join the SIT. Finally, when he walked into Datta's office, the Number 2 of the CBI was pondering over the matter of the 'human bomb'. He was looking at various reports, including the forensic analysis from the Tamil Nadu Forensics Lab, Central Forensic Science Laboratory of New Delhi and explosive experts from the NSG. These reports, put together, indicated that the body of a woman from the corpses collected after the blast threw significant leads. The torso and the right limb of the woman were blown into bits. The dismembered body showed pellet marks and burns. If the forensics maestro Chandrasekharan had pointed the finger of suspicion at the girl carrying the sandalwood garland standing inches away from Rajiv Gandhi moments before the blast, it was the SIT's responsibility to prove that the girl was indeed the human bomb that had killed Rajiv.

The CBI was still upset with Chandrasekharan leaking crucial evidence to the media before sharing it with the SIT. Even before the investigation started in full swing, lack of cooperation and blame games had ensued between the agencies. The R&AW was in disagreement with the IB on the role of the LTTE in the assassination. Tamil Nadu Police felt there was no point going after the LTTE in a state where the terrorist organization from